

EMERGENCY FIRST AID: MANAGING WOUNDS AND SEVERE BLEEDING

Step-by-Step Guide to Treating Injuries, from Minor Wounds to Life-Threatening Hemorrhages



PHASE 1: TREATING SIMPLE WOUNDS



SANITIZE FIRST

Wash your hands thoroughly or put on protective gloves before touching the wound to prevent infection.



CLEAN AND WASH

Wash the wound abundantly with water and soap to remove debris.

DISINFECT AND PROTECT



Apply an antiseptic to the area and cover the wound with a clean bandage or dressing.



PHASE 2: IDENTIFYING AND MANAGING SERIOUS WOUNDS

CRITERIA FOR "SERIOUS" WOUNDS

-  Extensive, deep
-  Involves crushed tissue (contused)
-  Bleeding heavily
-  Contains a foreign body

COVER AND ALERT



For serious wounds, cover the area with a clean cloth and immediately alert emergency services.



DO NOT DISTURB OBJECTS

If a foreign object is embedded in the wound, do not attempt to move or remove it, as this may increase damage or bleeding.

PROFESSIONAL CARE ONLY:

A first responder should only protect these wounds from further infection; all definitive cleaning and treatment must be performed by a doctor.



PHASE 3: CONTROLLING SEVERE BLEEDING (HEMORRHAGE)



APPLY DIRECT PRESSURE

Apply firm, direct pressure to the wound using a dressing or a specific compression point to stop blood flow.

WHEN TO AVOID PRESSURE



Do not apply direct pressure if there is a foreign body inside the wound or if there are multiple complex wound sites.

THE TOURNIQUET AS LAST RESORT



A tourniquet should only be used in exceptional situations: when bleeding persists despite all other efforts or when there are multiple victims and the responder must move on.



PHASE 4: TOURNIQUET APPLICATION TECHNIQUES



PROPER PLACEMENT AND MATERIAL

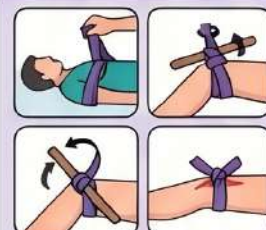
Apply the tourniquet to the upper arm or the thigh using a wide, non-elastic strap such as a scarf, tie, or belt.

TECHNIQUE 1: STANDARD MANUAL WRAP



Lay the victim down, maintain pressure, wrap a wide strap twice around the limb, pull the ends through the loop, and tie a knot tight enough to stop all bleeding.

TECHNIQUE 2: IMPROVED STICK TOURNIQUET (TOURNIQUET DE FORTUNE)



Wrap a wide strap twice and tie a knot; place a stick over the knot and tie two more knots over it, then rotate the stick until bleeding stops and secure it.



TIME IS CRITICAL

Once the tourniquet is set, never loosen it; you must note the exact hour and minute of application on a tag or the victim's clothing to track ischemia time.

